

HMF Design Clinic Rubric Sheet

A one-page rubric to keep beside you while you evaluate a team's Workbook. Detach and use it with the Grading Guide.

How the score is built. Grade every pain point on the three dimensions: **Problem Identifier** out of 5, **Solution Designer** out of 10, and **Value Communicator** out of 10, for 25 per pain point. Four pain points make a case study score out of 100, and the four case studies make an overall score out of 400.

The rubric, by dimension

Problem Identifier OUT OF 5

Did the team identify the real requirement behind the concern?

LEVEL	POINTS	WHAT THE TEAM'S ANSWER LOOKS LIKE AT THIS LEVEL
Complete	5	Pinpoints the underlying requirement or constraint behind the concern, the specific regulation, risk, or operational need, in Cedarline's own context, not just the surface ask.
Substantial	3 to 4	Identifies the concern and part of the underlying requirement, but misses some nuance or a constraint.
Developing	1 to 2	Restates the concern in general terms without naming the requirement behind it.
Minimal	0	Misreads the concern, addresses the wrong problem, or leaves it blank.

Solution Designer OUT OF 10

Did the team recommend the right Cisco solution and an approach that fits?

LEVEL	POINTS	WHAT THE TEAM'S ANSWER LOOKS LIKE AT THIS LEVEL
Complete	8 to 10	Names the right Cisco product or platform and the specific capability, with an architecture or approach that fits Cedarline and the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.
Substantial	5 to 7	Names the right product but is light on the capability, the architecture, or how it fits Cedarline.
Developing	2 to 4	Partly right: a loosely related product, or a product named with no approach or capability.
Minimal	0 to 1	Wrong product, a generic firewall with no specifics, or left blank.

Value Communicator OUT OF 10

Did the team explain how it works and the outcome for Cedarline?

LEVEL	POINTS	WHAT THE TEAM'S ANSWER LOOKS LIKE AT THIS LEVEL
Complete	8 to 10	Explains clearly how the solution works and states the concrete Cedarline outcome, in language the customer would understand.
Substantial	5 to 7	Explains how it works but is thin on the outcome, or states an outcome without explaining how.
Developing	2 to 4	Vague or generic: asserts it helps without explaining how or naming a specific outcome.
Minimal	0 to 1	No explanation and no outcome, or left blank.

From score to grade

Use these bands to sense-check the totals, then share the overall grade with the team as one of the three positive categories.

Pain point, out of 25

LEVEL	OUT OF 25	WHAT IT MEANS
Complete	22 to 25	All three dimensions strong: the requirement, the right solution and approach, and a clear how and outcome.
Substantial	16 to 21	Mostly there, with one dimension light or a gap in the approach or the outcome.
Developing	9 to 15	Partial across the dimensions: the idea is present but thin, generic, or missing the requirement or the solution.
Minimal	0 to 8	Little relevant content, or the main dimensions left blank.

Case study, out of 100

LEVEL	OUT OF 100	WHAT IT MEANS
Exemplary	85 to 100	Consistently complete answers across the four pain points, specific to Cedarline.
Proficient	65 to 84	Solid answers, with some gaps or generic reasoning in places.
Developing	40 to 64	Partial: the direction is right, but several answers are thin or incomplete.
Emerging	under 40	Mostly incomplete or off-target answers.

Overall grade, out of 400

LEVEL	OUT OF 400	WHAT IT MEANS
Best	300 to 400	Standout work. Across the four case studies the team read the requirements precisely, designed fitting Hybrid Mesh Firewall solutions, and told a clear Cedarline value story.
Better	200 to 299	Strong, consistent work. The team matched the right solutions across most pain points and communicated real value, with a few answers to sharpen.
Good	up to 199	A solid foundation to build on. The team engaged every case study and found real products; the next step is naming the requirement and the outcome more precisely.